# Lingjie (Jason) Chen

+1(217)-607-3395 | lingjie7@illinois.edu | https://lingjiechen2.github.io/

**Research Interests:** My research focuses on **language model design and training** to improve reasoning, generation efficiency, and scalability with data and compute. I am particularly interested in **diffusion language models**, exploring iterative refinement and parallel generation and their integration with existing language models and training and serving infrastructure.

## Education

**University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign** — Sep. 2025 - May 2030 (expected)
*Ph.D. in Computer Science* — *Urbana, IL*

**Fudan University** — Sep. 2021 - Jun. 2025
*B.S. in Data Science* — *Shanghai, China*
- Major GPA: **3.84/4.0**

**University of California, Berkeley** — Aug. 2023 - Jan. 2024
*Exchange Student, Statistics* — *Berkeley, CA*

## Publications

- **[C9] Unlocking Lossless Speedups in LLMs via Discrete Diffusion**
  Subham Sekhar Sahoo*, Lingjie Chen*, Khiem Pham*, Jonathan Geuter*, Chaitanya Dwivedi, Varad Pimpalkhute, Yash Akhauri, Alexander Moreno, Mikhail Yurochkin, Zhenting Wang, Mostafa Elhoushi, Nolan Dey, Shane Bergsma, Joel Hestness, John Thickstun, Eric Xing, Zhengzhong Liu
  Available on arXiv [Paper] [Project] *(* Core contributors)*
- **[C8] TAG-DLM: Diffusion Language Models for Text-Attributed Graph Learning**
  Lingjie Chen, Yuanchen Bei, Haobo Xu, Yanjun Zhao, Yuzhong Chen, Hanghang Tong
  Under Submission
- **[C7] TRIMS: Trajectory-Ranked Instruction Masked Supervision for Diffusion Language Models**
  Lingjie Chen, Ruizhong Qiu, Yuyu Fan, Yanjun Zhao, Hanghang Tong
  COLM 2026 [Paper]
- **[C6] `dLLM`: Simple Diffusion Language Modeling.**
  Zhanhui Zhou*, Lingjie Chen*, Hanghang Tong, Dawn Song
  ACL 2026, System Demonstrations [Paper]
- **[C5] Reasoning Traces Shape Outputs but Models Won't Say So.**
  Yijie Hao*, Lingjie Chen*, Ali Emami, Joyce C. Ho
  ACL 2026 [Paper]
- **[C4] VLMs Can Aggregate Scattered Training Patches.**
  Zhanhui Zhou, Lingjie Chen, Chao Yang, Chaochao Lu
  NeurIPS 2025 [Paper]
- **[C3] WAPITI: A Watermark for Finetuned Open-Source LLMs.**
  Lingjie Chen*, Ruizhong Qiu*, Siyu Yuan, Zhining Liu, Tianxin Wei, Hyunsik Yoo, Zhichen Zeng, Deqing Yang
  Available on arXiv [Paper]
- **[C2] Llama Scope: Extracting Millions of Features from Llama-3.1-8B with Sparse Autoencoders.**
  Zhengfu He, Wentao Shu, Xuyang Ge, Lingjie Chen, Junxuan Wang, Yunhua Zhou, Frances Liu, Qipeng Guo, Xuanjing Huang, Zuxuan Wu, Yu-Gang Jiang, Xipeng Qiu
  Available on arXiv [Paper]

- **[C1] "A good pun is its own reword": Can Large Language Models Understand Puns?**
  Zhijun Xu, Siyu Yuan, Lingjie Chen, Deqing Yang
  EMNLP 2024. [Paper]

## Employment Experience

**Institute of Foundation Models (IFM), MBZUAI** May 2026 - Sep. 2026

*Research Intern*

- Conducted research on large-scale post-training of large language models.
- Enabled the transition of a production-level model to diffusion-based generation.
- Contributed to the development and release of K2 Horizon, a family of open-source foundation models.

## Project Portfolio (Selected)

**dLLM** Sep. 2025 - Present

Lead Developer. [GitHub]

- Developed a lightweight training framework tailored for diffusion language models with **2,692 GitHub stars** (September 2026).
- Implemented modular components for noise scheduling, model wrapping, and logging.
- Enabled flexible experimentation with minimal boilerplate for research and prototyping.

**Sparse Autoencoder Framework** Jan. 2024 – Jul. 2024

Lead Developer. [GitHub]

- Provided a general codebase for conducting dictionary-learning-based mechanistic interpretability research.
- Developed tools for analyzing and visualizing the learned dictionaries.

## Tutorials

- **A Hands-on Tutorial for Diffusion Language Models with `dLLM`**
  Zhanhui Zhou, Lingjie Chen, Hanghang Tong, Dawn Song
  KDD 2026, Hands-on Tutorial. August 11, 2026. [Website] *(In-person presenter)*

## Academic Services

Reviewer, Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics **(ACL)**, 2025, 2026

Reviewer, Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing **(EMNLP)**, 2025, 2026

## Honors & Awards (Selected)

Fudan University Scholarship (Top 10%) **2021-2024**

Sou-Bin Scholarship (Top-performing students in Shanghai) **2019-2024**

Second Prize, CUMCM **2024**

## Skills

**Languages**: Mandarin (native), English (TOEFL: L30, R30, W25, S28)
**Programming**: Python, Linux, LaTeX, MATLAB, R, SQL, C/C++
**Frameworks**: PyTorch, Transformers, DeepSpeed, Accelerate